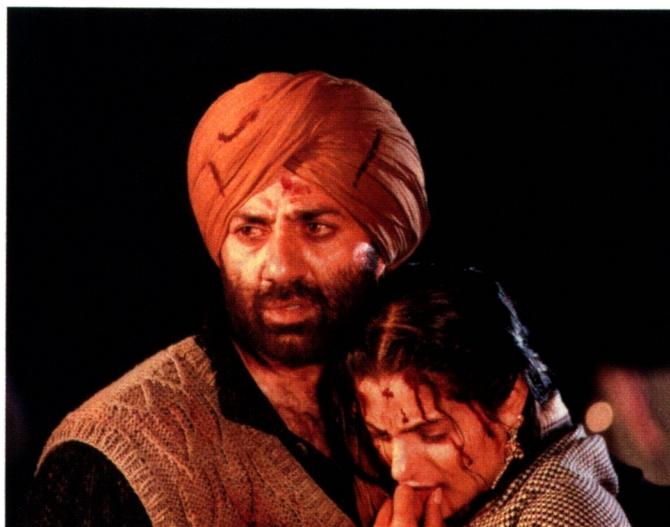


"LO, AB HO GAYI SIKHNI"

Imagine that a line such as this—equal parts pin-up patriotism and kitschy Bollywood romance—could become a political hot potato. In an age of intolerance, it did. *Gadar*, a typical Partition romance, set the box office on fire as it grossed over Rs 50 crore in two weeks, becoming one of the biggest hits in Bollywood ever. But the film more than lived up to its name outside the cinema, as it sparked off protests from the Muslim and Sikh communities to some scenes.



All it took was a determined group of 19 to do what the Third Reich, Imperial Japan and the nuclear power of Soviet Union couldn't—strike the military and financial heart of America. On September 11, two planes struck the towers of the World Trade Centre, killing 3,000 and reducing to rubble the most poignant symbol of America. Another plane hit the Pentagon military headquarters, while a fourth crashed in a field in Pennsylvania.

LAW OF THE LADY

J. Jayalalithaa



She may have been down but she was never out of the running for Tamil Nadu's top position. Despite being convicted in the TANSI land deal, J. Jayalalithaa was appointed chief minister after her victory in the assembly elections on May 14. In the process, she became only the second convicted political leader, after Kalyan Singh in Uttar Pradesh, to become a chief minister.



Two Much Trouble

V.V.S. Laxman's 376-run partnership with Rahul Dravid set the stage for India's thrilling 171-run victory over Australia at the Eden Gardens. Laxman scored 281, an Indian record at the time.



Rs 700

crore was the amount of money lost during all of the the January 2 Northern Grid power black-out. The grid failure left seven states and a union territory in darkness. Even VIP areas like the Rashtrapati Bhawan were not spared.